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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

2467

MEMCON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telephone Conversation with Prime Minister
Giulio Andreotti of Italy (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Giulio Andreotti, Prime Minister
Robert Hutchings, NSC Staff (Notetaker)
Sim Smiley (Interpreter)

DATE, TIME November 30, 1989, 8:59 - 9:28 a.m. EST
AND PLACE The Oval Office

The President initiated the call. (U)

The President: Good morning -- afternoon to you. (U)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Good morning. I want first to brief
you on my talks with President Gorbachev. (U)

The President: It was thoughtful of you. Thank you. (U)

Prime Minister Andreotti: First of all, Gorbachev expressed great
understanding for what the Western countries are doing for
perestroika. He was also concerned about public opinion, which
doesn't understand this is a difficult problem but an irreversible
process. He believes he will convene a December 12 meeting of the
Supreme Soviet. He is aware of the difficulties from
conservatives and progressives but is determined to achieve
success. Second, he placed great emphasis and importance to the
Helsinki platform, which means the U.S. is closely linked to
Europe. Gorbachev was quite clear on this point, also because the
Final Act specifies that borders are permanent and cannot be
changed. Third, great concern was expressed for the statements
made by Chancellor Kohl on reunification of the two Germanies.
This is not the time for such proposals, particularly with the
difficult situation of Poland and Hungary. (U)

The President: May I interrupt? Did he made any reference to
statements coming out of the U.S.? (U)

Prime Minister Andreotti: No, he just expressed hope that the
U.S. would support this stance of great prudence and caution.
This is not a subject to be decided today. On my side, I said in
my meeting with Mitterrand ten days ago at the EC, which made a
specific reference to the Helsinki Final Act, that not even
Chancellor Kohl made any reference to German reunification. There
was importance attached that military problems be faced only by
the two alliances as such, because of political changes in Eastern

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Europe, especially in the GDR and Poland. Without agreement by NATO and the Warsaw Pact, any decision would cause great problems for other countries. Furthermore, President Gorbachev expressed very great appreciation for the way the Chief of Staff of the USSR was received in the U.S. There was confidence and cordiality, which was very satisfactory also for the Soviet military. Then, great hope was expressed by both parties for accelerated progress in disarmament. The Italian side especially expressed the importance of a global ban on chemical weapons, which you, Mr. President, have stressed. (C)

The President: We are very interested. There are difficulties, not just on verification, but let me assure you we are very interested in working out a conclusion of an agreement on CW. (C)

Prime Minister Andreotti: There was a very strong commitment to enhance cooperation in the fight against drugs and terrorism. This morning during the meeting we heard news of the assassination of the President of the Deutsche Bank. Together we sent a message of condolence to Chancellor Kohl. Then President Gorbachev expressed concern that the EC might become closed upon itself, creating difficulty for those outside. I stressed that in December the EC will sign an agreement with the USSR. (C)

Then, the last point: regional crises. On the Middle East, they confirmed they are ready and willing to exert pressures to insure that Israelis and Palestinians meet. Also, in response to my question that they resume diplomatic relations with Israel, the response was positive. On Ethiopia, they reaffirmed their willingness to aid the process of negotiation. They said it had been a long time since they stopped supplying weapons. The news today suggests that negotiations between Ethiopia and the Eritrean rebels are going well. Finally, I raised Nicaragua, mentioning especially the accident of the two planes carrying arms destined for Salvador. I stressed that this made things more difficult, especially for the Esquipulas agreement. He answered that as he expressed to you his commitment that neither the Soviet Union nor any other Warsaw Pact country would supply arms, he stressed that he was remaining faithful to his commitment. Also, I met with Mrs. Chamorro a few days ago. Her criticism was not of a hostile person but of one who lived through the revolution against Somoza. We should all focus on the need for her election. (C)

This is about all. We also signed a number of agreements and also a joint statement, which was quite understated and satisfactory also for the Allies. (C)

The President: This has been very, very helpful. I have one question on the Middle East. Is this a correct statement: Gorbachev said the Soviet Union will resume diplomatic relations with Israel, but on the condition that Israel meet with the PLO? Is that correct? (C)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Correct, but I want to be more precise. They are ready to do so, but with precise guarantees. As you know, for some time we have asked Arafat to recognize Israel and Security Council resolutions 242 and 338. Now, when the PLO

acceded, Shamir said this was not enough and that he had no intention of talking with Arafat. Therefore the Soviet Union wants to be sure this will happen and that the two events be concurrent. Unfortunately, I'm afraid Shamir, whom I know well, does not wish to return the occupied territories in the West Bank and Gaza. We should remember that next month will be two years that the Intifada is going on -- a tragedy. (Ø)

The President: This is helpful. I think it would be good if the Soviet Union established diplomatic relations with Israel. I just wanted to make sure I understood the conditions. Thank you. (Ø)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Yes, Israel is very interested. Shamir, when he was here, asked me to pose the question to Mr. Gorbachev. (Ø)

The President: This has been a very helpful briefing. I can't tell you how much I appreciate it. For your information, I've been trying to downplay some of the extreme expectations about the Malta meeting. I will not surprise the Allies. I will have an opportunity to visit with you in Brussels. You should know we are moving into the meeting in a forward-leaning position. We will not be negative. We don't want to compound his problems. We want to find ways to help him in a spirit of cooperation, giving him credit for his role in the favorable changes we have seen, and with a determination that we can move forward on arms control and other issues. I know you are interested, and I can assure you I am not going in with a negative mood. I have a good feeling about the Malta meeting. (Ø)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Thank you very much. I wanted to ask you a question. Will our conversation remain private and confidential? (U)

The President: I would request, if it is agreeable to you, that I have our Press Secretary announce to the U.S. press that we had a good, in depth conversation, with no reference to the substance of our talk. (U)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Exactly. I agree completely. (U)

The President: Wonderful. We will tell our Press Secretary. Thank you very much. With your experience and judgment, your comments have been very helpful to me. (U)

Prime Minister Andreotti: Thank you very much. Good luck in Malta. (U)

The President: Thank you. I will see you Monday. (U)

-- End of Conversation --